INDIA AND THE MAJOR POWERS

India and United States of America

In the present international scenario, with the overwhelming presence of United States of America as the sole surviving Super Power, it is important for any student of Indian foreign policy to analyze the ever-evolving Indo-US relations in the post-cold war international relations.

Immediately after independence, till the end of Cold War, and a decade after that, Indo-US relations did not mark any significant developments. Bilateral relations between the two could not develop properly, because of Cold War calculations that conditioned Indo-US relations. Initially, India's posture of non-alignment did not find favour in the US. John Foster Dulles condemned non-alignment as "immoral". Later, certain other issues cropped up which obstructed the natural growth of bilateral relations between the two. Kashmir has been one such issue and the US favouring a plebiscite in Kashmir as per the UN resolution of 1948 and 1949, made India cautious about the US. Moreover, India's recognition of Communist China in 1949, roping in of Pakistan into military alliances like Baghdad Pact (1955–1958), SEATO (1954) and CENTO (1958–1979) and subsequent US arms supply to Pakistan to "contain" Communism became major irritants in the Indo-US relations. The Korean crisis and India's refusal to endorse the US sponsored "Uniting for Peace Resolution" distanced the two. The Indo-Russian Treaty of Friendship of 1971 further embittered the Indo-US relations. Again during the 1971 Bangladesh liberation war, relations reached a low point. The US supported Pakistan and even tried to negotiate a cease-fire through the UNSC. However, the Soviets vetoed it. The US even moved their 7th Fleet to the Bay of Bengal to create pressure on India. The Soviet Union had come to India's rescue and they sent their Fleets to Bay of Bengal to counter the US pressure. The 1974 Pokhran Nuclear explosion by India also distanced the two countries. But one point of consideration is that, despite such irritants, in the spheres of economic, culture and education, cooperation continued. The US also provided technical